



Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting February 13th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vqfSbh4WIBE
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Delaware County Redevelopment Commission <U+2014> Regular Meeting Report

Meeting Date: Thursday, February 13, 2025

Report Type: Structured Municipal Meeting Analysis

Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission was called to order on Thursday, February 13, 2025, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Mr. Adams, Mr. Key, Mr. Henry, Mr. Brown, Ms. Batters, Ms. Green (Presiding Officer).
 - Members Absent: None explicitly noted.
 - Presiding Officer: Ms. Green.

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Agenda Reordering:** At the request of Auditor Ed Carroll, agenda item #18 was moved to take place between items #4 and #5.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** Approval of January Meeting Minutes 00:02:17
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Noted as the longest set of minutes seen; members confirmed they had a chance to read them.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve made by Rob (Mr. Brown), seconded by a board member. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously.

Substantive Business & Board Action

1. 00:02:54 Auditor's Report on Claims and Checks

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed Carroll, Delaware County Auditor
- **Deliberation Summary:** Auditor Carroll presented copies of claims and returned checks from vendors following a data entry error where a single invoice was paid three times on the same day due to mismatched invoice numbers entered into the VIP system. To prevent duplicate payouts, the auditor's office instituted a new check-and-balance policy: departments will no longer submit paper claim forms that require manual re-entry by the auditor's staff; claims must be submitted electronically through the system to automatically flag duplicates. The returned check has been collected and applied back to the fund's balance.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presented; received and filed.

2. 00:06:23 2025 Bids for Mowing DCRC Owned Properties

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Engineering
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the RFP for 2025 mowing services on Delaware County Redevelopment Commission (DCRC) owned properties. Minor corrections were identified, and the RFP is ready to be sent to previous vendors (such as J-Crew) and posted on the website. Board members discussed timing for the first mowing (typically late March) and the possibility of approving modifications via email.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table initially made, then withdrawn 00:09:02, followed by a motion to approve pending minor review. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously (00:09:18). *(Note: The board later revisited and re-tabled the road/tift review context 00:14:59 / 00:15:09 to audit expected revenues vs. bond reports).*

3. 00:15:25 Yorktown Downtown Development Assistance & Paving Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jay (Town of Yorktown representative)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Jay provided an update on Yorktown's Downtown Development Assistance for a 117-unit commercial/residential building project behind Town Hall. The project's financial gap has been reduced to approximately \$3 million after receiving a \$1 million Ready Grant. No funding request was brought at this time. Additionally, an update was provided on the 2025 paving request (Ice and Augle Road project, approved last year for \$40,005, starting late May). Finally, a new request was introduced for a traffic study agreement and preliminary engineering work at Tiger Drive and River Road, totaling \$88,620 (with Yorktown requesting the DCRC split the cost). Board members raised questions regarding whether Yorktown Council had already agreed to fund it entirely and discussed traffic bottlenecks near the school.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for further review 00:22:42. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:22:51.

4. 00:22:58 Jackson Street Stormwater Project Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Town of Yorktown representative
- **Deliberation Summary:** Follow-up on a stormwater issue on Jackson Street west of the interstate. Alternative #3 (perforated pipe drainage solution) was recommended as the preferred slow-drainage method to avoid downstream flooding. Estimated capital cost is \$93,500 plus \$37,000 in soft costs (total \$130,500). Yorktown brings in about \$80,000 annually for stormwater and requested financial partnership from the DCRC to cover half of the capital portion.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for further office review and alternative solutions 00:26:19. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:26:45.

5. 00:27:04 23rd Street Trail Project Future Discussion

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Engineering representative
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on the 23rd Street Trail project (from Cowan to Gallery). Plans are complete and ready to bid, with design adjustments made to avoid a railroad parcel. However, negotiations with Norfolk Southern remain stalled over structures installed in the railroad right-of-way and the railroad's request for "Z-gates" (pedestrian crossing safety gates). The commission previously rejected Z-gates. The board requested a review of the original proposal, updated cost estimates including the Z-gates, and updated schedules.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table the request to gather original proposals and Z-gate cost estimates 00:32:36. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:34:47.

6. 00:34:58 Isaiah 117 House Development Agreement Amendment

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Hannah / Board representative
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of Resolution 2025-1 to amend the economic development agreement with Isaiah 117 House, extending construction and permit deadlines. Ground was broken on January 17th. State permit updates required an indoor fire sprinkler system, adding to the budget. The addendum extends the agreement deadline to January 31, 2026.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 25-1 and the development agreement addendum approved. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [00:38:11](#).

7. [00:38:31](#) Project Johnny: Baker Tilly Cost-Benefit Analysis Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members / Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a \$3,000 cost-benefit analysis proposal from Baker Tilly for Project Johnny. Because non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) were signed in executive session, details were restricted. The board discussed splitting the \$3,000 cost (\$1,500 each) with the applicant, on the condition that the Redevelopment Commission receives the study results.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to proceed with the proposal to split the study cost with the applicant. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [00:39:51](#).

8. [00:39:59](#) Website and Agenda Posting Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amber / Kyle Johnson
- **Deliberation Summary:** Update on updating the DCRC website hosted on the county's platform. Amber volunteered to help Kyle Johnson update content and upload commission information, agendas, and packets. A request was made to establish a deadline of the Friday prior for agenda items so packets can be posted by the Tuesday before meetings.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal vote required.

9. [00:37:34](#) (Out of sequence on transcript) Sidewalk Project Phases 2, 3, and 4

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Engineering representative
- **Deliberation Summary:** Update on remaining sidewalk construction phases (phases 2, 3, and 4). Designs are complete. Phase 2 may require the acquisition of three parcels, though one parcel could potentially be eliminated if a curb is omitted at one corner while remaining ADA-compliant.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to proceed with Phase 2 [00:42:53](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [00:43:06](#).

10. [00:44:12](#) Sheriff's Office Vehicle Purchase Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Office Representative

- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to purchase 2025 Dodge Durango pursuit vehicles instead of previously requested 2023 Dodge Chargers from an Ohio dealer. Sourced locally via GAF, the Durangos cost approximately \$1,200 more than the Chargers but offer two model years newer, increased interior space for SWAT/crash team equipment, a superior factory warranty (5-year/60,000-mile vs. 3-year/36,000-mile), all-wheel drive, and include all equipment (lights, mounts, wiring, labor, laptop cradles, and striping). The board discussed fleet conditions, vehicle replacement budgets, and funding the purchase out of TIF districts.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve the purchase of the 2025 vehicles using TIF funds as presented 00:52:00. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:53:51.

11. 00:53:51 Muncie-Delaware County Economic Development Alliance: Target Industry Study

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tracy Stults, Muncie-Delaware County Economic Development Alliance
- **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of a 2025 Target Industry Study project<U+2014>a deep-dive, data-driven analysis of the existing industry base (Advanced Manufacturing, Logistics, Agriculture, Healthcare, Tech) to identify future job and investment opportunities. Proposals range from \$50,000 to over \$100,000. A grant request for \$50,000 has been submitted to the George and Frances Ball Foundation. Stults noted a potential funding gap and stated she would return to the DCRC for financial support at a future meeting. Board members volunteered to join an ad-hoc review committee.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no vote taken.

12. 00:57:52 Shell Industrial Site Infrastructure Installation Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Project Manager / Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Project update regarding the Shell industrial site infrastructure. Significant drainage issues were identified last March, leading to an agreement amendment in July. Following the election, the project was paused in November to brief new commission members. The project manager requested direction to resume work and highlighted potential traffic model adjustments if a prospective company locates there, which may necessitate an additional access road. The board discussed scheduling an executive session to review confidential project details.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to set an executive session for March 13, 2025, immediately following the regular meeting 00:10:41. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 01:04:53.

13. 01:05:24 3710 North Morrison Road Update & Ratification of Amendment Three

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members / Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Ratification of Amendment Three, previously discussed at the last meeting, regarding an extension for closing the sale of 3710 North Morrison Road (the fourth parcel). Because the addendum required signing before February 1st, Amber executed it prior to the meeting.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve ratification [01:06:12](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [01:06:33](#).

14. [01:06:33](#) Westel Board Introduction and Wastewater Infrastructure Discussion

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie Malcom, Westel Board Member
- **Deliberation Summary:** Carrie Malcom introduced herself as a newly elected Westel board member (along with board members Amy Townson, Brittany mock, Shane Williams, and Larry Batt). Malcom inquired whether there was lingering interest in reviving the regional wastewater line project discussed two years ago to connect Gaston out to I-69. Board members and staff noted that original ARAR funds were reallocated, previous DCRC funds were rescinded back to the TIF district, and the critical path currently involves addressing inflow and infiltration (I&I) lines running beneath the Westel school building.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational introduction; board expressed willingness to review updated engineering figures if brought forward.

15. [01:14:40](#) Innovation Connect 2025 Operational Support Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ted (Innovation Connect)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Ted presented the 2025 operational funding request for Innovation Connect (\$50,000), highlighting impacts from 2024 (27 resident businesses, 450 community businesses served, 1,000+ entrepreneurs reached, numerous events, tech-wise academy STEM outreach for 1,500 kids, and international Soft Landings designation). Projected 2025 expenses are approximately \$980,000, with cash flow strain anticipated in the first three quarters prior to receiving state certified tech park funding. Innovation Connect requested \$50,000 to bridge cash flow.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve the \$50,000 funding request [01:29:41](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously ([01:29:43](#)).

16. [01:30:29](#) Scanning Historical Documents

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle / Amber
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on digitizing physical document boxes (claims, economic development agreements, resolutions, ordinances) dating back years. Scanning quotes from third parties range around 40 cents a page. Staff suggested utilizing college interns working 4 hours a week to scan documents internally, starting with the past 5 years of records to make them searchable.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to scan the past five years of documents utilizing available interns [01:36:34](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [01:36:53](#).

17. [01:37:15](#) Hiring an Executive Director & Establishing Committees / Bylaws

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Henry / Board Members
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the necessity of hiring an Executive Director to relieve administrative burdens currently placed on county attorneys and staff (Danielle and John). Mr. Henry shared a proposed job description with the President and recommended forming an ad-hoc committee (comprising less than a board majority) to post the position, conduct interviews, and make recommendations. The board also briefly discussed establishing formal bylaws for committee operations under state statutes.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to establish an ad-hoc committee to review the job description, post the position, and conduct interviews [01:39:00](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously ([01:40:06](#)).

18. [01:41:48](#) Interlocal Agreement with Monroe Township Trustee

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle
- **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of an interlocal agreement between the DCRC and the Monroe Township Trustee. The trustee requires this agreement for State Board of Accounts compliance to pay Mr. Cooper for trees already planted as part of the county sidewalk project.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve the interlocal agreement [01:43:20](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously ([01:43:40](#)).

19. [01:43:53](#) R.I.D. Dues Renewal

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Danielle
- **Deliberation Summary:** Review of R.I.D. organization dues renewal. The renewal cycle runs July through June. Staff recommended paying dues to maintain membership through the current term.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to pay the R.I.D. dues for the current cycle [01:45:01](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously ([01:45:18](#)).

20. [01:45:32](#) USI Insurance Renewal

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Pulling the USI insurance renewal off the table for action.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to pull from the table and approve the insurance renewal [01:45:33](#) / [01:46:50](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously ([01:47:08](#)).

21. [01:47:43](#) Cooper Landscaping / Nursery Paving Assistance Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jared Cooper (Cooper Landscaping)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Jared Cooper appeared before the board requesting financial assistance (approximately \$68,000) to cover the finish coat of asphalt required by the city for his nursery property located on the city/county line. Cooper stated he originally approached the county, was redirected to the city, then to the Revolving Loan Fund, and ultimately secured bank financing just to cover the base coat (\$120,000), depleting funds intended for building operations. Board members advised Cooper to acquire competing quotes from additional paving companies (such as Milestone and Midwest Paving) and return for the next meeting.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No immediate action; carried over to the next meeting pending additional quotes [01:52:34](#).

22. [01:48:48](#) Review of Claims and Invoices

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members / Auditor
- **Deliberation Summary:** Board members reviewed specific claims, including AT&T ARP Broadband payments (\$214,500 and \$99,000 for rural broadband projects in Delville and Albany areas), Brook LLC invoices, and American Structurepoint bridge engineering claims. Questions were raised regarding potential duplicate entries for American Structurepoint regarding Bridge 75 (comparing invoice #47948 versus #7898). Staff clarified that invoice #7898 was the correct updated claim. Additional discussion occurred regarding a past \$100 line-item dispute concerning an FBI badge/lanyard inquiry which had been adjusted by the auditor.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve all claims as presented, with staff directed to verify and reconcile the American Structurepoint Bridge 75 invoices prior to final payout [02:05:03](#). Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously ([02:05:10](#)).

Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [02:05:55](#) **Christopher Gamber:** Addressed the board regarding a \$100 claim from a previous meeting concerning an FBI/SBOA-related call. Inquired whether the funds had been reimbursed and expressed confusion over conflicting explanations provided by staff regarding whether the claim belonged to the DCRC. Staff and board members clarified that the \$100 was removed/adjusted prior to final payment.
 - [02:10:20](#) **Rick Yenser (Newsmen and Author):** Stated he arrived approximately 45 minutes prior, found no agenda posted or available, and that records requests were unfulfilled. Criticized transparency regarding the county sidewalk project (specifically tree removal near schools) and public access to meeting agendas and prior meeting minutes. Urged County government to be more open and compliant with state records laws.
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Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Next regular meeting scheduled for **March 13, 2025**, at which Baker Tilly will present the 2025 Bond Report.
 - Executive Session scheduled for March 13, 2025, immediately following the regular meeting to discuss confidential project matters.
 - **Adjournment:** Official meeting adjourned following public comment and final votes.
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